Harbor Street Community Garden Committee: Minutes

Date: Tuesday, October 21 **Time:** 7:04 p.m. to 7:31 p.m. **Place:** Library room B **Present:** Maria (chair), Tom, Priya, Luis, Ann **Apologies:** Devon

Decisions

- **Raised beds approved.** The committee approved spending $2,400 on eight raised beds, 4 to 1. Maria, Luis, Ann and Priya voted in favor. Tom voted against.
- **Shed postponed to spring.** No one objected. It will be revisited at the March meeting.

Actions

Who	What	By
Maria	Place the lumber order with Harbor Lumber	November 15
Tom	Call the right person at public works about the water hookup permit: how long it takes, and whether a hookup is allowed on that side of the fence. Report back.	Next meeting (November 18)
Priya	Send out the build-day volunteer sign-up form	October 28
Luis	Ask the scout troop to volunteer for build day	Not set
Ann	Draft a one-page proposal on opening some plots to people outside the current area	November 18

Discussion

1. Treasurer's report

Ann reported a balance of $5,180 as of October 20. This is after the seed order, and nothing else has come in. There were no questions.

2. Raised beds

Harbor Lumber quoted $2,310 for lumber for eight beds, plus $90 for screws and corner brackets, $2,400 in total. Luis moved to approve $2,400 and Ann seconded.

Tom said he would rather wait for spring pricing, since lumber is usually cheaper in March, and he thought the committee would be paying a premium. He is not against the beds. Priya argued for building in December while volunteers are available, because many will have left by spring.

The motion passed 4 to 1. Tom asked that his objection be recorded and said he accepts the outcome.

Maria will order the lumber by November 15. Harbor Lumber expects delivery about two weeks after the order, so late November.

3. Shed

Luis priced a 6 x 8 kit at about $1,100. The committee cannot fund both the shed and the beds, so the shed was postponed to spring.

4. Water

Tom spoke to someone at public works, though not the right person. The hookup needs a permit, and the fee is $85. Tom does not yet know how long the permit takes. Priya asked whether a hookup is allowed on that side of the fence, and Tom does not know yet. He will find out and report at the next meeting.

5. Volunteers

Priya proposed a build day on Saturday, December 6, at 9 a.m. Twelve people are needed and seven have said yes so far. Priya will send the sign-up form by October 28, and Luis will ask the scout troop.

6. Plot eligibility

Ann raised an early idea. Plots are currently open only to residents of Harbor Street and the two surrounding blocks, and a few people have asked about opening some to outsiders. She has no proposal yet and will write a one-page proposal to bring to the committee. Tom asked that it address the waitlist, as Harbor Street residents have waited about two years.

Next meeting

Tuesday, November 18, 7 p.m., library room B.

Minutes prepared from an auto-transcript. Room audio was poor, so please send corrections to Maria.